Table 10.4: ICMR Recommended Dietary Allowances for Proteins

Group	Particulars	Protein requirement g/day
Man	Sedentary work	60
	Moderate work	
	Heavy work	
Woman	Sedentary work	55
	Moderate work	
	Heavy work	
	Pregnant woman	82.2
	Lactation (0- 6 months)	77.9
	Lactation (6-12 months)	70.2
Infants	0 – 6 months	1.16 g/kg/ day
	6 – 12 months	1.69g/kg/ day
Children	1 -3 years	16.7
	4 – 6 years	20.1
	7 – 9 years	29.5
Boys	10 -12 years	39.9
Girls	10 -12 years	40.4
Boys	13 – 15 years	54.3
Girls	13 – 15 years	51.9
Boys	16 -17 years	61.5
Girls	16 – 17 years	55.5

occurring most frequently in infants and young children and often associated with infection (WHO,1973)

PEM affects children under 5 years of age belonging to the poor underprivileged communities. Under nutrition is a complex condition with multiple deficiencies such as proteins, energy and micronutrient deficiencies often occurring together. According to WHO, malnutrition is an underlying factor in over 50 % of the 10 – 11 million yearly deaths of children under 5 years.

10.7.2 Classification of PEM

Protein energy malnutrition may be classified into three types as follows:

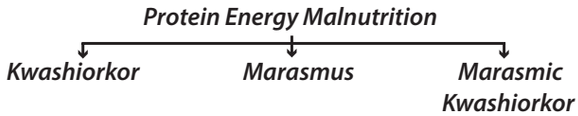


Fig 10.6: Classification of PEM

10.7.3 Causes of PEM

PEM is prevalent in all parts of the world and in all ages. It is primarily a disease that occurs in young children who live in poverty. In India, PEM is the most widespread form of malnutrition among pre-school children. A majority of them suffer from varying grades of malnutrition.

The paths leading from early weaning to Nutritional marasmus and from protracted breast feeding to kwashiorkor is schematically presented below:

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